Vopak

South Africa liquid fuels market story

Inland supply, corridor capture and tank turnover

Durban–Lesedi corridor into Gauteng

11 October 2026

Public evidence and illustrative capture cases. Customer access, operating limits and returns remain provisional.

Photo source: Royal Vopak | Terminal Durban | vopak.com



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South Africa remains an import-led fuel market, making customer capture Vopak's priority

SITUATION

A large fuel market relies on substantial imports

pp3–6, 23

2025 demand is estimated at 21.0bn litres: 8.9bn petrol and 12.1bn diesel, down from 21.9bn in 2023. Road use dominates. At the assumed 5.8bn litres of domestic production, gross import need is about 16.7bn litres.

COMPLICATION

Sector growth supports demand, but fuel use, supply and routes are changing

		Deep dive
Mining, manufacturing and agriculture	Production, exports and harvests drive diesel use in equipment and freight; sector growth paths differ.	p7
Eskom and power generation	Recovery reduces peaking and backup diesel at utilities, mines, factories and farms, while supporting activity.	p8
Road-to-rail shift and vehicle efficiency	Moving goods from trucks to rail and improving vehicle efficiency reduce fuel consumed per unit of activity.	pp9, 22
Refineries and domestic fuel production	Higher output or restarts displace imports relative to the 5.8bn-litre assumption; lower output increases import need.	p10
Matola and inland routes	Matola provides an alternative gateway for inland supply; delivered cost, reliability and access determine its reach.	p11

RESOLUTION

Vopak should secure customer capture before expanding

pp12–15

Base imports remain about 16.6bn litres in 2030. Illustrative capture is 2.63bn litres through Durban, including 1.32bn onward through Lesedi within the same flow; this fits the preliminary working-tank screen.

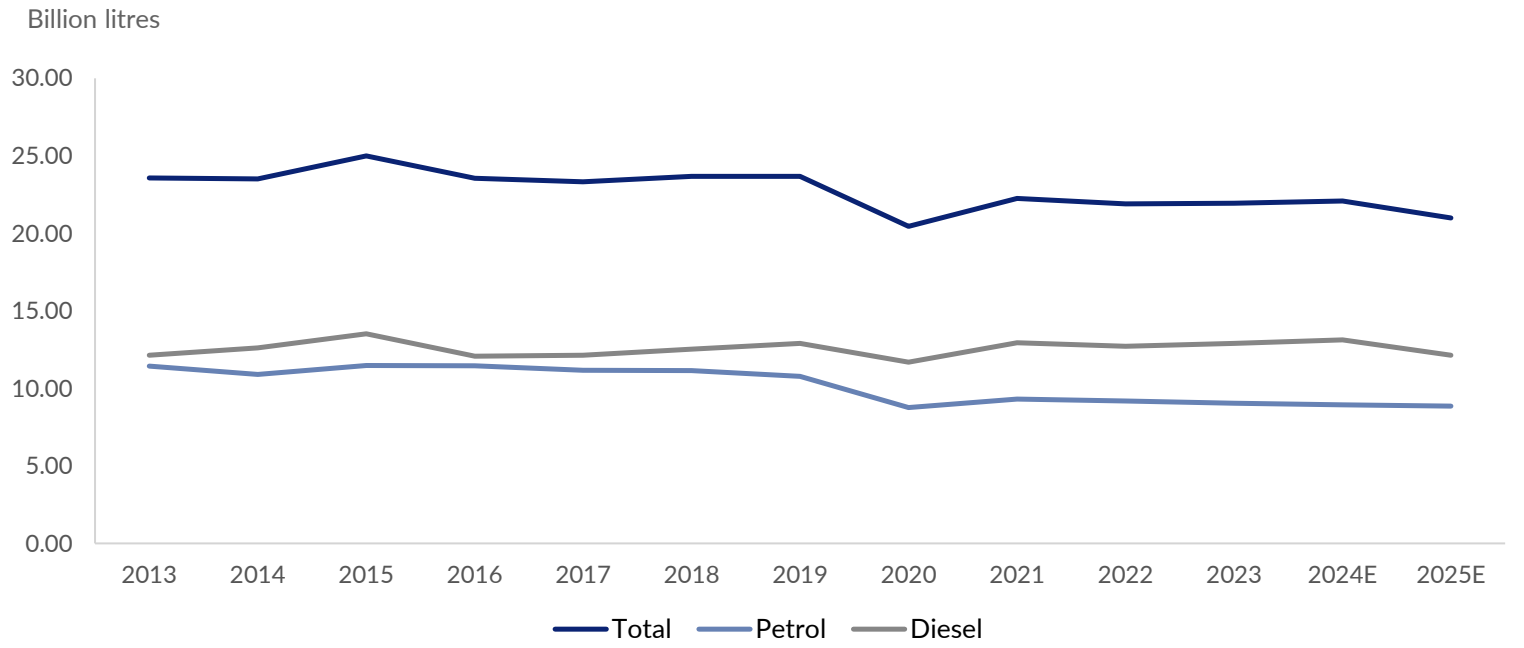
Expansion requires secured incremental volumes and a demonstrated capacity shortfall.

Analytical workbook v02 and market-sizing analysis. Demand is estimated; production and capture are planning assumptions. Product reconciliation remains open;

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Fuel demand has eased to 21.0bn litres and stays broadly flat through 2030 in the base case

National fuel demand, 2013–2025



Five drivers of the outlook

Sectors: activity supports demand.

Eskom: recovery lowers power fuel use.

Road-to-rail and efficiency reduce road fuel use.

Refineries: recovery displaces imports.

Matola: an alternative gateway competes for inland flows.

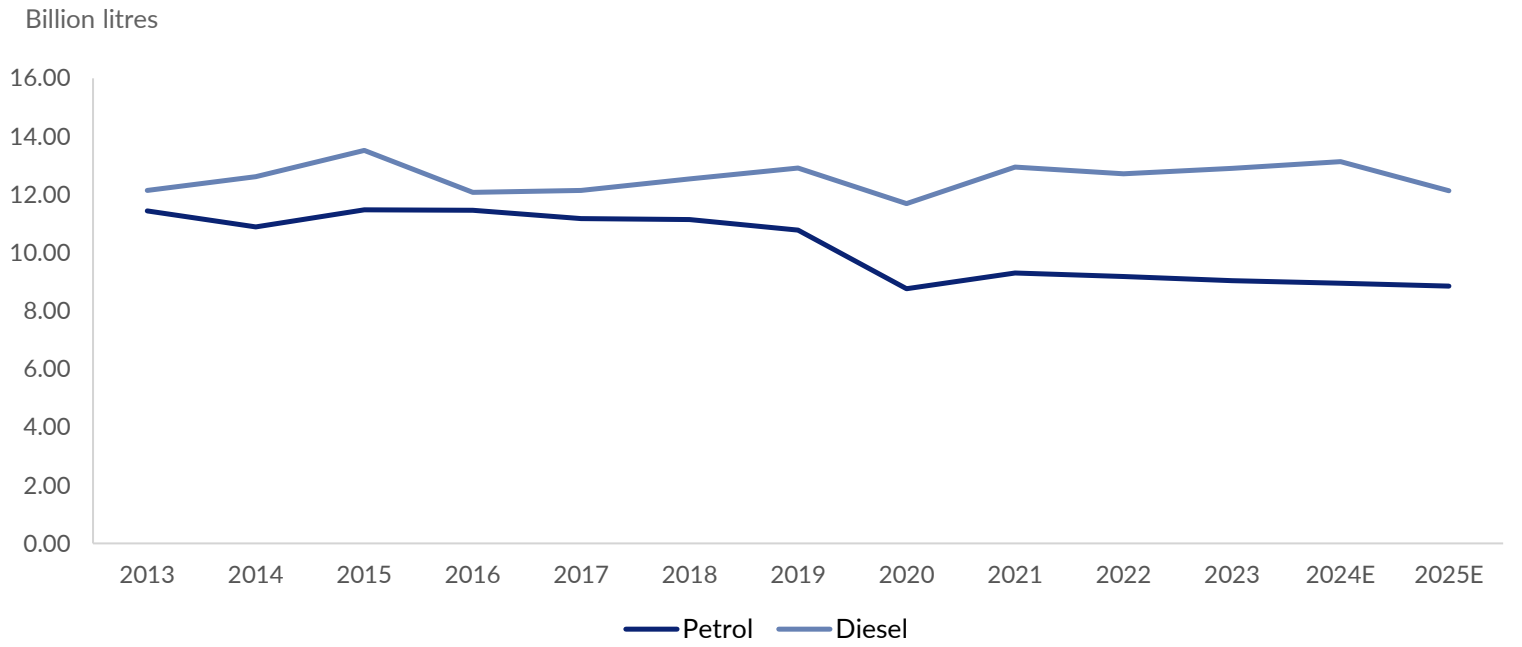
2030 base: 20.9bn L demand; 16.6bn L gross imports.

Demand determines consumption, domestic production determines import need, and competing gateways determine Durban's share.

Department sales 2013–2023; analytical workbook v02. E = estimated 2024–2025. 2030 is the base scenario, not an observed outcome.

Petrol has declined since 2013, while diesel has sustained the market

Petrol and diesel demand, 2013–2025



Petrol demand outlook

Petrol: 9.04bn L in 2023 to 8.86bn L in 2025E.

Assumed efficiency and fleet changes outweigh activity growth.

Diesel: 12.13bn L in 2025E.

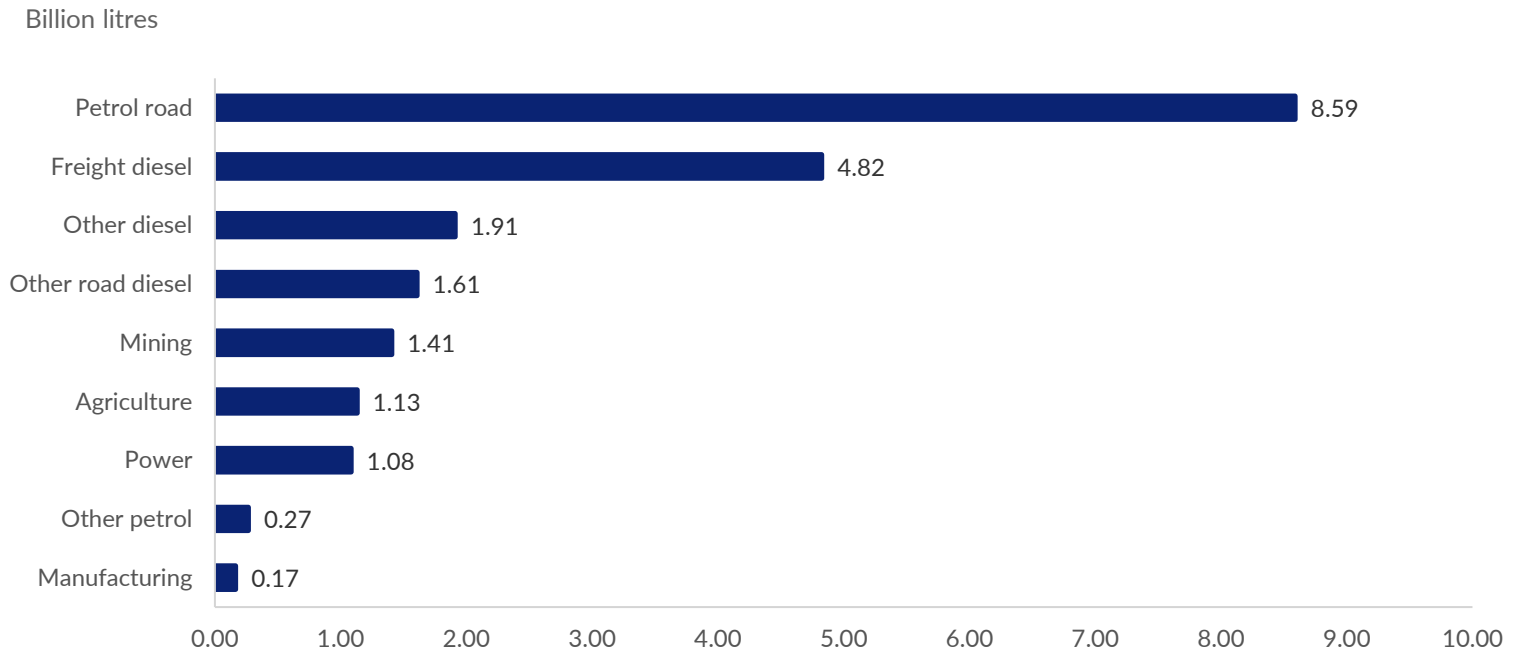
2013–23: reported Department series. 2024–25: estimates.

Petrol remains below its earlier level; diesel demand responds more directly to freight, industry and power.

Department annual sales, 2013–2023. Estimated 2024–2025: analytical workbook v02. The Department series is used consistently.

Road use dominates the baseline, with meaningful diesel demand outside transport

2025 estimated demand by use



Demand allocation

Road freight: 4.82bn L

Mining: 1.41bn L

Agriculture: 1.13bn L

Other diesel: 1.91bn L remains unallocated to a specific end use.

Sector-attributed vehicle fuel stays in its sector; the road split is an explicit allocation assumption.

Analytical workbook v02, Segments. 2021 energy-balance road volume; 75% of road diesel allocated to freight. Historical sector intensities at current activity.

The 5.8bn-litre production assumption leaves a gross import requirement of about 16.7bn litres

2025 national balance	bn litres	Basis
Demand	20.99	Estimated from the 2023 sales baseline
Domestic production	5.80	National planning assumption
Gross imports	16.70	SARS recorded customs litres
Exports	1.55	SARS recorded customs litres
Production + net imports	20.95	Availability before stock / statistical differences
Availability less demand	-0.03	Aggregate near-balance; product differences remain

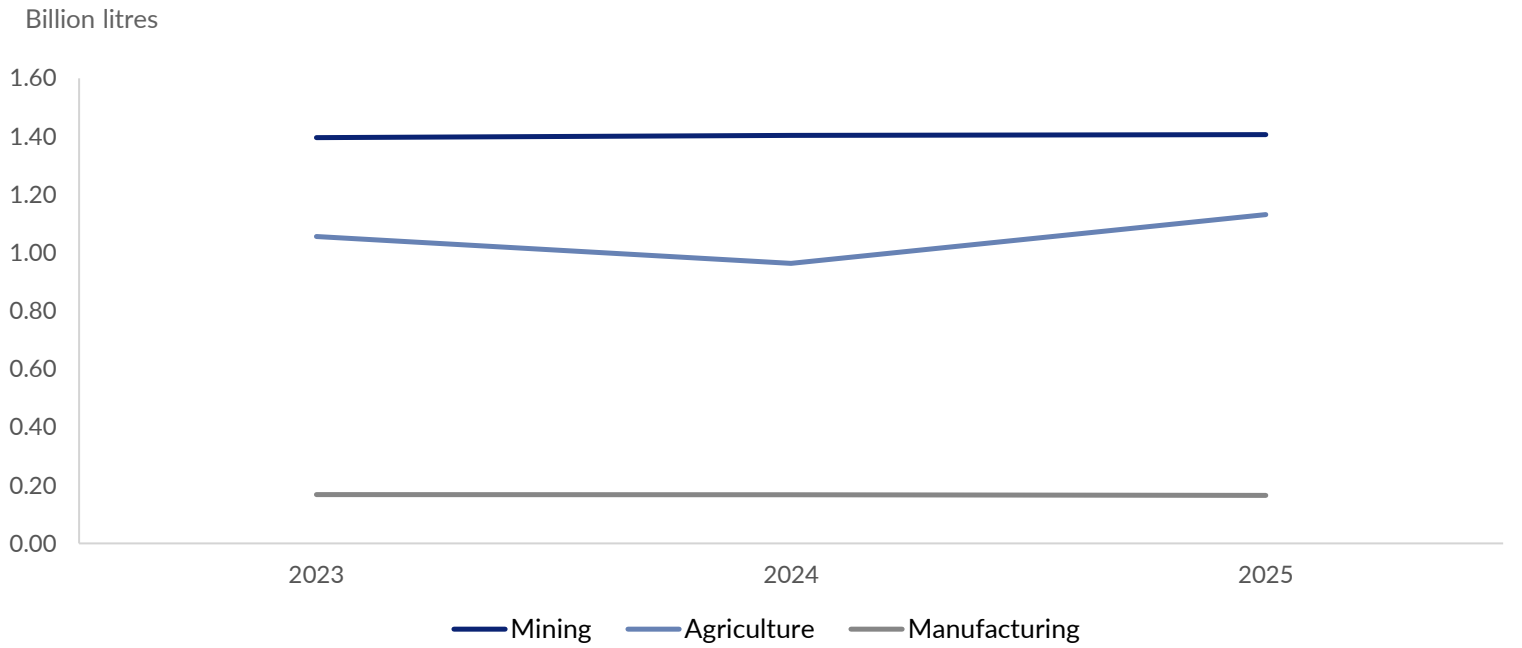
5.8bn litres sets the planning case. Aggregate closure does not validate domestic output or its petrol/diesel split.

Analytical workbook v02, Balance and Supply assumption. National production planning assumption. Original plant-based estimate 10.23bn L retained in appendix.

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Agricultural demand rebounds in 2025 while mining and manufacturing remain broadly flat

Estimated sector diesel demand



Estimated diesel use

Mining: 1.40 → 1.41bn L

Agriculture: 1.06 → 1.13bn L

Manufacturing: about 0.17bn L

Manufacturing covers the energy-balance industry residual, not a complete industrial census.

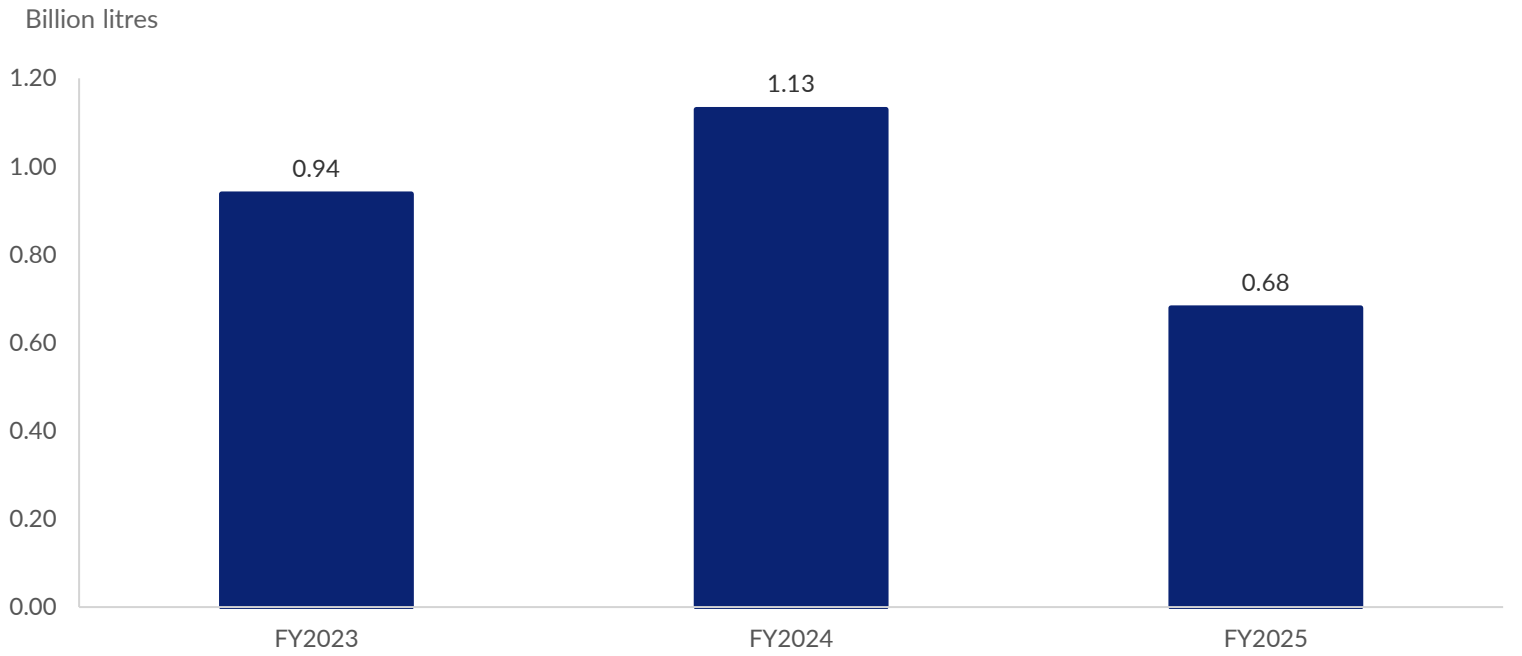
Sector activity produces different demand paths; applying one GDP growth rate would hide these differences.

Stats SA mining/manufacturing indices and agriculture real GVA; mean 2018–2021 fuel intensity. Sector diesel values after 2021 are estimates.

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Eskom’s fuel use fell by 40% in FY2025 as electricity supply improved

Eskom diesel and kerosene use



Lower power-related fuel use

Eskom diesel and kerosene fell from 1.130bn L in FY2024 to 0.679bn L in FY2025.

Better supply can also reduce backup diesel at mines, factories and farms.

Private backup use is estimated separately; it is not measured by this Eskom series.

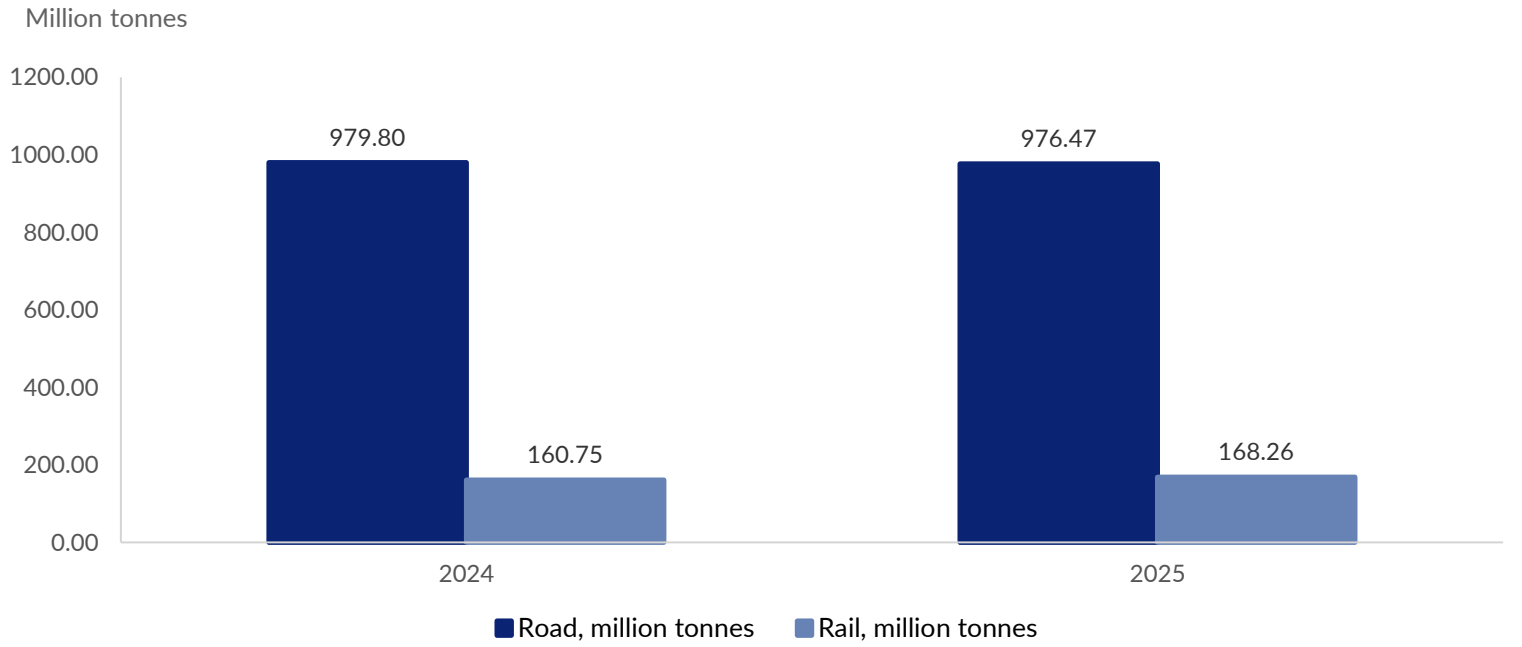
Power recovery reduces a source of diesel demand created by electricity shortages; the 2030 assumptions are in the appendix.

Eskom Integrated Report 2025, p141. Fiscal years end in March. Reported series includes diesel and kerosene; private backup consumption is outside this series.

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Rail volumes are recovering, creating scope to reduce road diesel use

Reported road and rail freight



Recovery and displacement

Rail: 160.7m tonnes in 2024 to 168.3m in 2025. Road: 979.8m to 976.5m tonnes.

A shift of mining, agricultural and manufactured goods to rail can reduce truck fuel use.

Rail growth alone does not prove road displacement; distance, cargo and traction mix matter.

Road remains the dominant freight mode; sustained rail recovery could change the diesel required to move goods.

Stats SA P7162 December 2025 p7; all reported freight. Analytical workbook v02, Evidence.

Changes in refinery output alter the volume that imports must supply

Domestic supply	Reported evidence	Implication for imports
Secunda	Refined-products output: 29.1m barrels in FY2024; 27.6m in FY2025; 30.6m in FY2026	Operating recovery can increase domestic supply; petrol and diesel yields determine import displacement.
Natref	Sasol-reported output: 17.8m barrels in FY2024; 14.7m in FY2025; 25.8m in FY2026	FY2026 includes above-share production, so the latest reported change cannot be treated as a like-for-like change in whole-plant output.
Astron	Reported refined products: 166,204 billion Btu in 2024; 164,365 billion Btu in 2025	Output and product mix affect supply; energy units require conversion before comparison with customs litres.
SAPREF and PetroSA	No refining contribution included in the 2025 production assessment	Restored refining would displace imports only when plants produce saleable products. Terminal handling is not refinery output.

Domestic production can recover or fall independently of demand; actual output and product yields determine the import requirement.

Sasol production metrics FY2025 and FY2026; Glencore annual reports 2024 and 2025; 2025 plant assessment. Fiscal and calendar periods and reporting scopes differ. Restart sensitivities are in the appendix.

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Matola provides an existing alternative gateway for inland fuel supply

Node	Evidence	Implication for South African fuel routes
Galp/IPG Matola	60,000m³ petrol/diesel storage; opened 2020	Existing import and distribution infrastructure
Petromoc Língamo / Matola	390,000m³ across liquid fuels	Broader storage base; product allocation and overlap need confirmation
Beira, Nacala and Pemba	Existing central / northern logistics nodes	Regional supply; no additional SA flow assigned in the base case
Temane PSA	Light oil, gas and LPG; production began December 2025	No direct finished petrol/diesel output credited
Komatipoort recorded imports	0.303bn L in 2022 → 0.086bn L in 2025	Current cross-border flow is far smaller than gross storage suggests

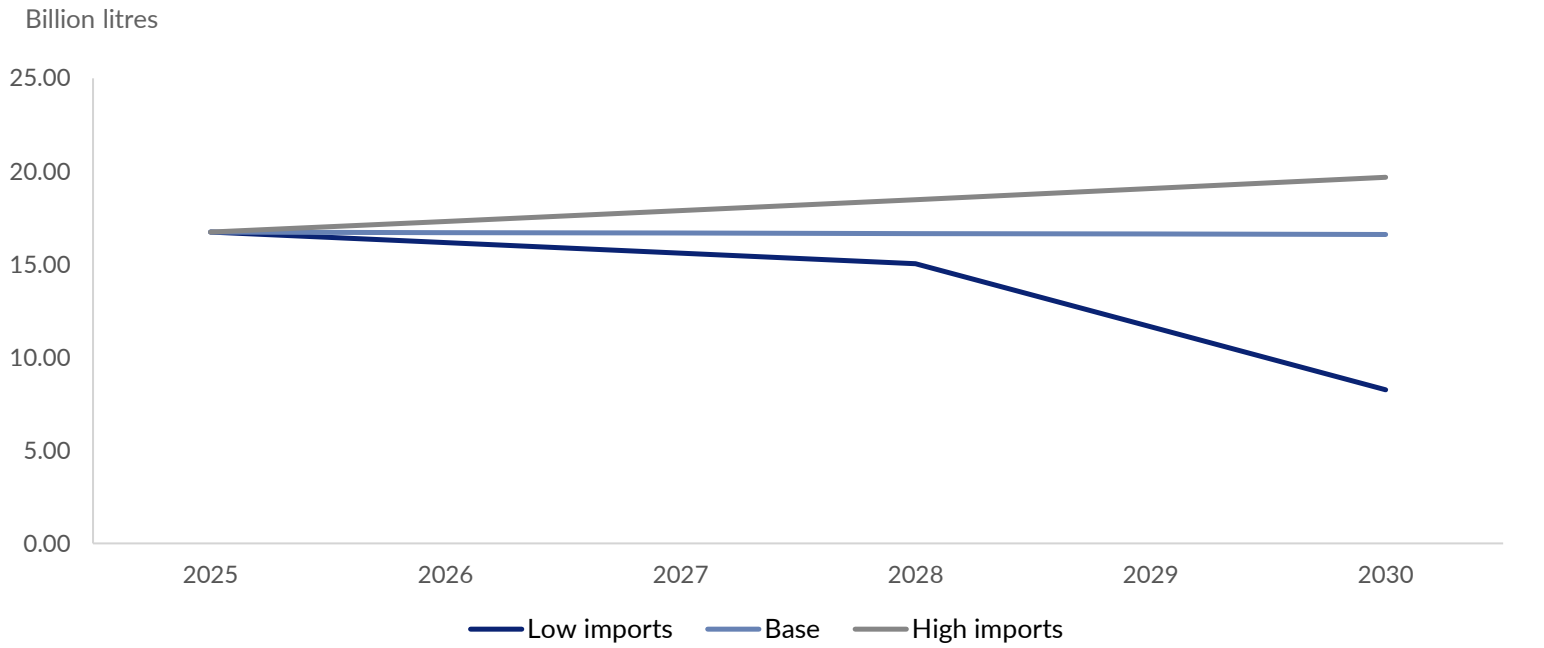
Matola's infrastructure creates an alternative supply route; recorded cross-border flows remain much smaller than storage capacity.

Galp Matola commissioning release, 3 December 2020; Petromoc logistics disclosures; Sasol Mozambique operations; SARS customs, 2022 and 2025. Storage is not annual throughput.

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The base case leaves imports near 16.6bn litres in 2030, with refinery recovery driving the downside

Gross import requirement, 2025–2030



2030 gross import need

Low imports: 8.26bn L

Base: 16.61bn L

High imports: 19.68bn L

Cases are sensitivities, not assigned probabilities.

The base case balances activity growth against efficiency, rail and power reductions; supply assumptions drive the widest spread.

Analytical workbook v02, Scenarios. Demand-implied gross imports = demand – domestic supply + 2025 exports. Zero stock change; 5.8bn L assumed opening supply.

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Vopak's capture depends on the accessible share of Durban imports

Market / flow measure	Annual volume	Meaning for Vopak
National demand, 2025 estimate	20.99bn litres	Total consumption context
National gross imports, 2025	16.70bn litres	All recorded import gateways
Durban customs imports, 2025	13.16bn litres	Gateway proxy before customer and route allocation
Illustrative Durban capture	2.63bn litres	20% of Durban gateway volume; no contracted share inferred
Illustrative onward Lesedi flow	1.32bn litres	50% of captured Durban flow; counted within the same fuel volume

The illustrative unique flow is 2.63bn litres. Adding Lesedi would double-count fuel handled at both sites.

Market-sizing analysis, October 2026. Capture is total conditional flow, not incremental sales; domestic and other-terminal Lesedi receipts are outside this screen.

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The illustrative capture case fits the tank-turn screen, making usable capacity the next test

Site	Illustrative flow bn L/year	Handling screen bn L/year	Operating basis
Durban	2.63	3.50	146,000m³ estimated working subset; two turns/month
Lesedi	1.32	2.98	124,000m³ working capacity, partly estimated; two turns/month
Investment test	Incremental contracts	Actual constraint	Receipt, product segregation, dispatch, pipeline access and peak demand

Working-tank arithmetic screens feasibility. Engineering limits and current customer flows determine actual headroom.

Terminal working-capacity assessment, October 2026. Durban working subset is not the full terminal; access, peaks and current throughput remain open.

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The market supports an import platform; customer capture and capacity constraints govern investment

Conclusion	Evidence from this story	Decision implication
A substantial demand base	2025 estimated demand of 21.0bn litres	Prioritise identifiable customer segments and destinations
Base imports remain substantial	About 16.6bn litres in 2030 under the 5.8bn supply case	Plan for ongoing imports; retain refinery sensitivities
Gateways compete for the same fuel	Mozambique base diversion of 0.20bn L is a route assumption	Validate delivered cost, service and customer access
Expansion follows incremental capture	Illustrative 2.63bn L unique flow fits the tank-turn screen	Secure additional volumes, prove the bottleneck, then compare improvement and expansion returns

Next decisions: review the product balance, obtain route quotes and customer commitments, and establish usable capacity at both sites.

2025 analytical workbook v02: demand assumptions and 5.8bn L domestic production case. Estimates are not reported actuals.

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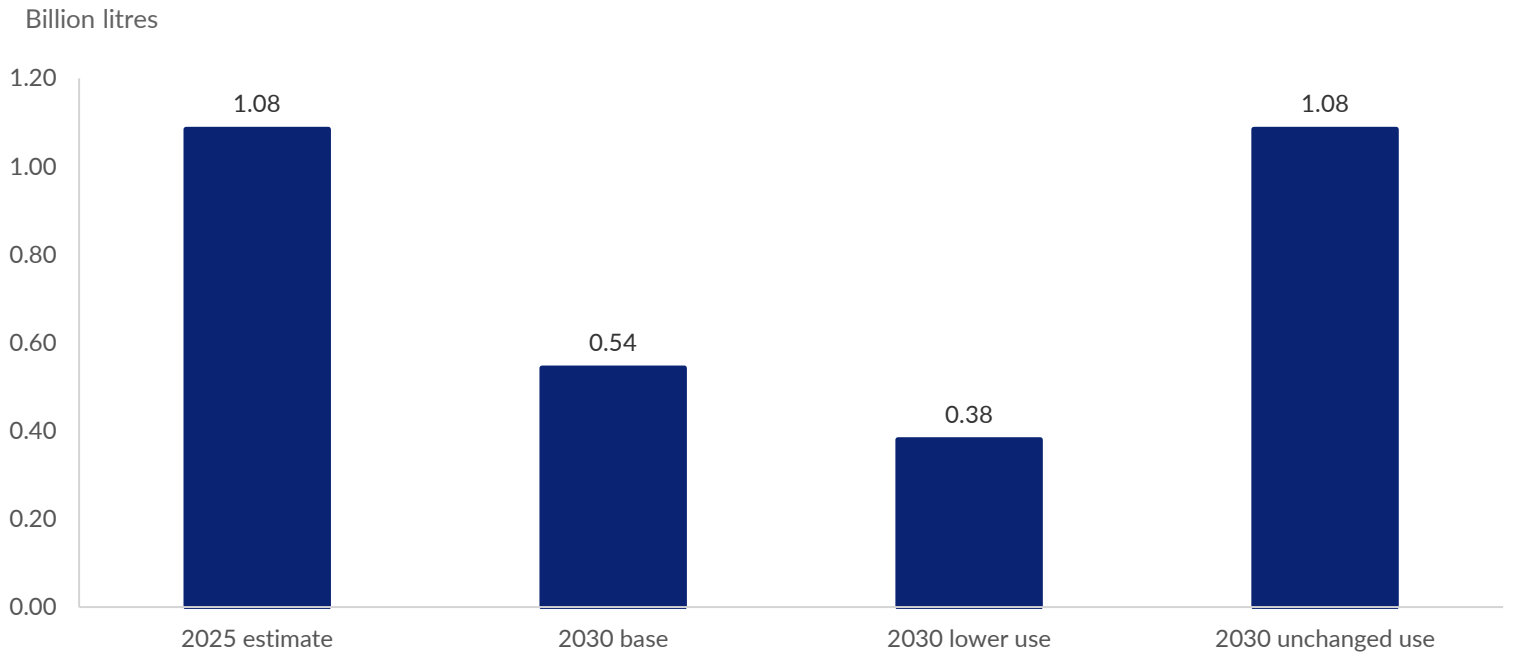
Appendix

Supporting analysis and assumptions

Power and freight sensitivities • Refinery and route assumptions
Product balance • Demand methodology • Sources

Further power recovery halves fuel demand to 0.54bn litres in the 2030 base case

Power fuel demand across scenarios



Base case and sensitivities

2025 estimate: 1.08bn L, including 0.20bn L assumed private backup.

Base: 50% retained in 2030; a 0.54bn L reduction.

Lower-use case: 35% retained. Unchanged-use case: 100% retained.

Improved electricity supply lowers peaking and backup fuel use, even where transport and industrial activity continue to grow.

Analytical workbook v02: calculated power baseline and 2030 retention assumptions. Estimated utility/private scope includes FY proxies and IPP conversion. Scenario endpoints, not forecasts of annual dispatch.

A 7.5% shift of road-freight activity to rail saves 0.33bn litres in the base case

2030 case	Road-freight shift	Net diesel reduction
Low imports	15.0%	0.62bn litres
Base	7.5%	0.33bn litres
High imports	2.5%	0.12bn litres
Calculation order	Activity → efficiency → modal shift	10% diesel rebound allowance for rail

These shifts apply to road-freight activity, not the entire diesel market; sector demand and power remain separate.

Analytical workbook v02, Driver bridge and scenario assumptions. Shift interpreted as freight tonne-km share. Distances and eligibility remain assumed; cases also vary growth and efficiency.

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Refinery restart assumptions drive the lower-import sensitivity

Supply lever	Base case	Low-import sensitivity
Operating domestic supply	5.8bn L through 2030	15% increase in the national planning volume
SAPREF	No refining restart through 2030	Assumed 2029 start; 65% utilisation after a two-year ramp
PetroSA / Mossel Bay	No refining restart through 2030	Assumed 2029 start; 50% utilisation after a two-year ramp
Combined restart contribution	Zero	5.67bn L petrol/diesel in 2030

Restart dates and ramp-up settings are scenario assumptions. Import-terminal operations can compete before refining resumes.

Refinery production and restart scenario assumptions. Capacity inputs: SAPREF 180kb/d, PetroSA 45kb/d; 70% petrol/diesel yield in restart sensitivities. Dates are not project commitments.

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Illustrative route costs put Matola at a R0.19-per-litre logistics premium

Route sensitivity	Result	Assumptions behind the result
Durban → same inland destination	R0.95 per litre logistics	600km one way; round trip; R25/truck-km; 40,000L payload
Matola → same inland destination	R1.14 per litre logistics	550km one way; terminal and border costs; one-day delay
Matola premium	R0.19 per litre	Required landed-product discount under these illustrative costs
Border-delay sensitivity	R0.09–R0.40 per litre premium	Zero to three delay days
Base incremental Mozambique flow	0.20bn L by 2030	About 15 additional loaded trucks/day over 330 days

Mozambique diversion changes the gateway serving demand. It does not reduce South Africa's national import requirement.

Analytical workbook v02, Mozambique. Distances, tariffs, border charges, financing and allocation are illustrative sensitivities, not carrier quotes or confirmed access.

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The national supply assumption closes the total balance but leaves the product mix unresolved

2025 measure	Petrol bn L	Diesel bn L	Total bn L
2025 demand	8.86	12.13	20.99
Domestic production	3.20	2.60	5.80
Gross customs imports	4.45	12.25	16.70
Customs exports	0.80	0.75	1.55
Supply plus net imports	6.85	14.10	20.95
Unexplained availability less demand	-2.00	1.97	-0.03

The 5.8bn L planning case uses the original estimated production mix. Offsetting product differences remain visible; no product allocation is claimed as verified.

Analytical workbook v02, Supply assumption and Balance. Original plant estimate: Secunda 3.95, Natref 2.37, Astron 3.91bn L; 10.23bn total. These do not govern the planning case.

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Efficiency offsets activity growth in the petrol baseline

Demand component	Assumption / result	How it enters the estimate
Petrol activity	+0.5% per year in 2024–2025	More vehicle use supports consumption
Petrol fuel intensity	−1.5% per year in 2024–2025	A combined efficiency / fleet-mix assumption reduces fuel per unit of activity
Petrol demand	9.04bn L in 2023 → 8.86bn L in 2025	Compounding activity and intensity yields a modest decline
2030 road outlook	Base: 1% annual efficiency improvement	Applied after activity growth; rail displacement is then applied to freight only

The assumptions are explicit and editable; EV uptake is not counted again as a separate reduction.

Department 2023 sales; analytical workbook v02, Assumptions and Demand history. Activity and efficiency settings are illustrative planning assumptions.

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Our 2025 baseline is 21.0bn litres, with road use accounting for most demand

Demand segment	2025 estimate bn litres	Change since 2023 bn litres
Petrol road use	8.59	-0.18
Mining	1.41	0.01
Manufacturing	0.17	0.00
Agriculture	1.13	0.08
Utility and private power	1.08	-0.99
Road freight diesel	4.82	-0.02
Other road diesel	1.61	-0.01
Other petrol	0.27	-0.01
Other diesel / unallocated	1.91	0.16

Petrol: 8.86bn L. Diesel: 12.13bn L. Total demand falls from 21.94bn L in 2023 to an estimated 20.99bn L in 2025.

Department sales through 2023; energy balances and Stats SA activity; Eskom/IPP evidence. All 2025 segment allocations are estimates; other diesel retains an explicit residual.

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Source definitions and explicit assumptions underpin the demand and import outlook

Evidence / assumption	Pages	Source and analytical treatment
National sales and sector activity	3–7, 22–23	Department sales, energy balances and Stats SA activity. Demand after 2023 is estimated; segment boundaries retain an unallocated residual.
Power and freight	8–9, 17–18	Eskom fuel and Stats SA freight observations. Private backup, future rail shift and efficiency remain explicit planning assumptions.
Domestic supply and imports	6, 10, 12, 19, 21	Sasol and Glencore plant disclosures; SARS trade. The 5.8bn-litre national production case is an assumption; product reconciliation remains open.
Matola infrastructure and costs	11, 20	Operator infrastructure disclosures and SARS customs. Logistics costs are illustrative, rather than carrier quotations.
Vopak capture and capacity	13–15	Illustrative gateway capture and working-tank turnover. Customer commitments and engineering constraints determine achievable volumes.

Observed data, estimates and scenario assumptions are labelled separately throughout the analysis.

Sources: Department energy statistics; Stats SA; Eskom; Sasol; Glencore; SARS; Galp; Petromoc. Supporting calculations: analytical workbook v02 and market-sizing workbook.

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